
Echo Barrier Hub

Raising Purchase Orders & the Intercompany Pipeline

A hands-on, click-by-click guide for testers

What the Hub is. One internal platform for Echo Barrier's entire purchase-order journey — a depot raises an order, it is approved up the intercompany chain (Depot → EB Group → EB SRO), the supplier manufactures it, and the goods ship back to the depot. Everything — approvals, documents, tracking, invoices — lives in one place, with each person seeing only what their role needs.

Please read first — this is a sandbox. You are testing a *staging* copy. It is deliberately **not** wired to the live accounting system, so **judge the workflow and the experience, not the exact numbers or addresses** (some are still placeholders). Nothing you click here can affect production or send anything to a supplier.

How to read this guide. Numbered orange markers (1, 2, ...) on each screenshot match the numbered steps in the text — they show you *exactly where to click*. Green boxes explain **why** something works the way it does.

Where. <https://echo-hub-staging.netlify.app/> — your test logins are in §3.

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1. Why the Hub works this way

Before the clicks, the one idea that makes everything else make sense: **a depot never buys straight from the factory.** An order is passed *between three separate Echo Barrier companies*, and each one places its own purchase order with the next:

The depot (e.g. US – Baltimore) needs stock. It raises a request *to EB Group*.

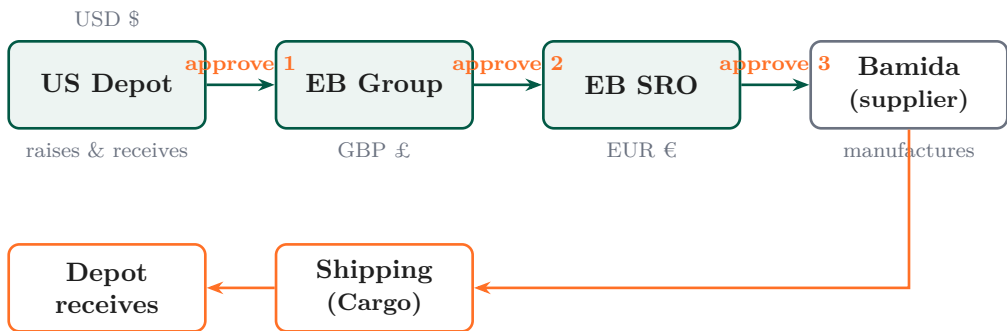
EB Group (the UK/Ireland company) buys from *EB SRO*.

EB SRO (the Slovakian company) places the real manufacturing order with the *supplier* (Bamida).

Why? Each hop is a genuine sale between two *legal companies*, in different countries and currencies. That is why every leg is its own purchase order, with its own approval, its own PO number and its own currency — it is what customs, intercompany transfer pricing, and each company’s own accounts require. The Hub simply makes that chain fast, visible and traceable instead of a pile of emails.

2. The pipeline at a glance

Every order travels the same path. Three approval gates move it down the chain; the cost is shown in each company’s own currency, converted automatically.

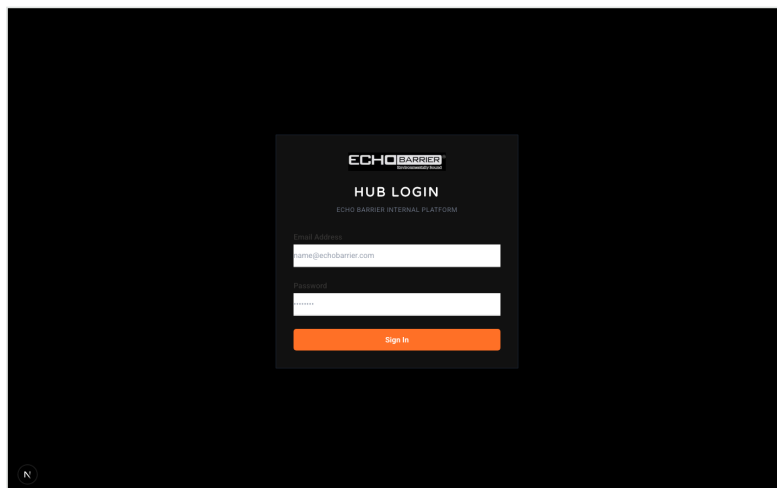


Stage	What happens & who does it
Raise	A depot (Sales) creates the order and sends it for approval.
Approve 1 (Depot → Group)	Manager approves; the Group → SRO order is auto-created.
Approve 2 (Group → SRO)	Manager approves; the SRO → Supplier order is auto-created.
Approve 3 (SRO → Supplier)	Manager approves; the manufacturing order (Bamida) is authorised in accounting.
Manufacture, ship, receive	Goods are produced, shipped via Cargo, and received at the depot (Production).

3. Getting in & finding your way around

Open <https://echo-hub-staging.netlify.app/> and sign in. Three test accounts are set up for you — each is a different *role*, so it's worth trying all of them to see how the Hub changes per person:

Role	Email	Password
Manager	manager@echobarrier.com	manager-development-2231
Sales	sales@echobarrier.com	sales-development-3231
Production	production@echobarrier.com	production-development-4231



Once in, the **left sidebar** is how you move around. You will only see the items your role allows: **Dashboard** your landing page — a quick overview.

Quotes customer quotations (Sales).

Purchase Orders the heart of this guide — raise, approve and track POs.

Bill of Materials the parts & specs that make up each product.

Transport container & shipment tracking.

Invoices intercompany commercial invoices.

MRP stock & manufacturing forecasting.

Your name and a **Sign Out** button sit at the bottom of the sidebar.

Why? The menu is filtered to your role, so nobody is faced with buttons they can't use. A **Production** user, for instance, never sees prices or the Quotes page — only what they need to receive goods.

4. Raising a purchase order

This starts the whole pipeline. Do it as a **Sales** (or admin) account. In the sidebar click **Purchase Orders**, then the orange **+ Raise PO** button in the top-right. You'll see this form:

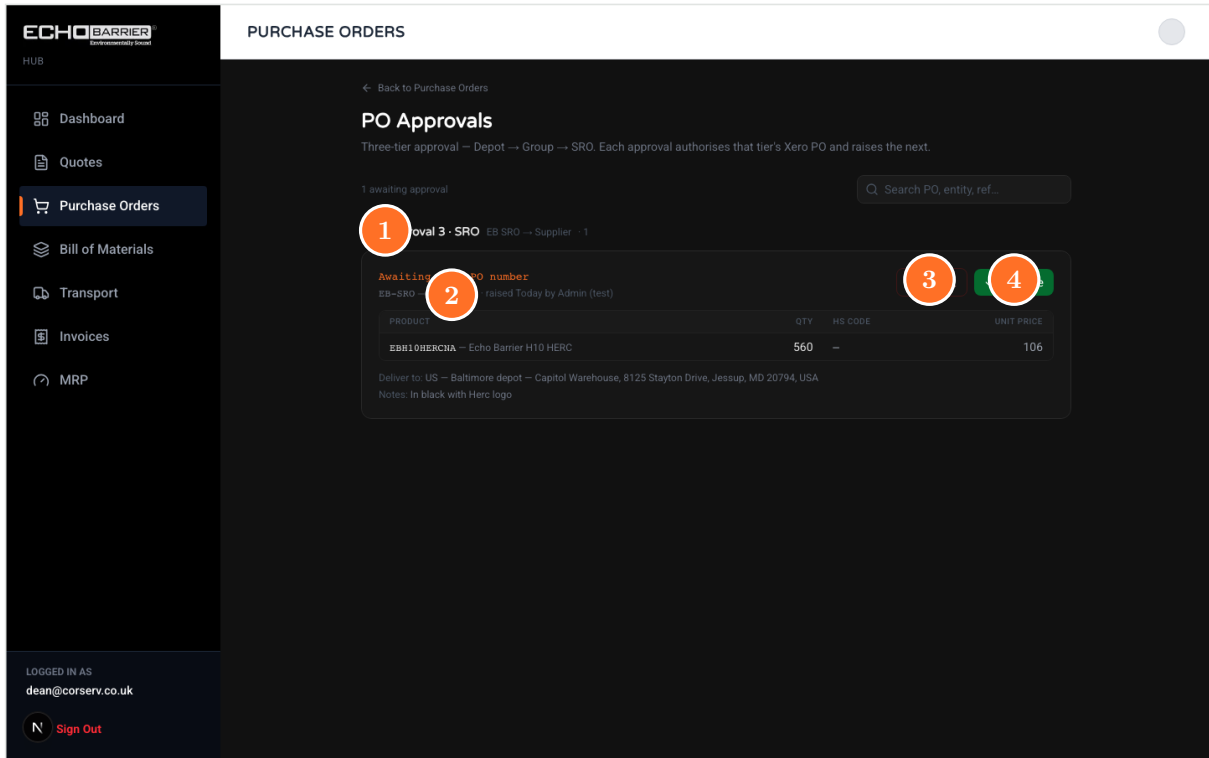
- 1 **Raising depot** Choose the depot the stock is for (e.g. **US-BAL**). The small note beneath confirms it is *Raised to EB-GROUP* — every depot order goes to EB Group first.
- 2 **Delivery address Required** — where the goods should ship to.
- 3 **Notes** Anything EB Group should know (priority, context). Free text.
- 4 **Product** Pick the item. Only real catalogue products appear.
- 5 **Quantity** How many. A yellow “*Stock short*” hint may appear — it is only a heads-up and never blocks you.
- 6 **Unit price** The cost (only visible to accounts with cost access). A greyed *Xero code* appears under the line so accounting can match it.
- 7 **Add line** Add more products to the *same* order.
- 8 **Raise PO for approval** Submits it. The order now sits in the approval queue — you’ll see a green “Purchase order raised” confirmation.

Tip. Order the same things regularly? Fill the form once, then click **Save as template** (top of the form). Next time, choose it under **Load from template** and every field is pre-filled.

Why? Notice the PO number is *not* shown yet. The Hub never invents numbers — the official one comes from accounting after approval (see §8). Until then the order is tracked internally and simply reads “Awaiting Xero PO number”.

5. The approval system — how the chain actually works

This is the core of the Hub. Approvals are done by a **Manager** (or admin). Click **Purchase Orders** then the **Approvals** button (top-right, it shows an orange count when orders are waiting). Orders are grouped into the three tiers.



- 1 **The tier** Orders are grouped **Approval 1 – Depot**, **2 – Group**, **3 – SRO**. That number tells you where in the chain the order is.
- 2 **The order** Each card shows the route (FROM → TO, e.g. EB-SRO → SUPPLIER), who raised it and when, its line items, and — when present — a *ref:* line linking it back to the order it came from, so the chain is traceable right back to the depot that started it.
- 3 **Reject** Stops the chain at this tier (you can add a reason).
- 4 **Approve** Advances the order — see below.

5.1 What “Approve” actually does

Approving a tier does three things *in one atomic step* (all-or-nothing):

1. marks this leg **approved**, recording *who* approved it and *when*;
2. automatically **raises the next leg** into the queue — so approving the Depot order makes the Group order appear, approving Group makes the SRO order appear, and so on — carrying the **reference** forward;
3. hands the approved leg to **accounting**, which creates the real purchase order and sends its official **Xero PO number** back to the Hub.

So you approve three times in total, and the order walks itself down the chain:

Depot $\xrightarrow{\text{approve 1}}$ Group $\xrightarrow{\text{approve 2}}$ SRO $\xrightarrow{\text{approve 3}}$ Supplier (Bamida)

Why? We made approval a single atomic step (rather than “mark approved”, then separately “create the next order”) so a half-finished approval can never leave an order stranded with no next step — an earlier problem this design fixed. It also means two managers clicking at once can’t accidentally create a duplicate order.

Tip. **Approval 3 – SRO** is the one that authorises real manufacturing. In this sandbox that hand-off is switched off, so nothing reaches a supplier — approve it freely to see the flow complete.

6. Tracking every order on the board

Clicking **Purchase Orders** opens the **board**. This is your live map of every order.

- 1 **Approvals** Jump to the approval queue (§6); the badge shows how many are waiting.
- 2 **+ Raise PO** Start a new order (§5).
- 3 **Status tiles** At-a-glance counts — Total Active, Awaiting Approval, In Manufacturing, Shipping.
- 4 **Kanban / Table** Switch between the card board and a dense table.
- 5 **Search** Filter by PO number, entity, status or SKU.
- 6 **Lifecycle columns** The order’s journey, left to right: *Depot → Group, Group → S.R.O., S.R.O., Sent to manufacturing, Manufacturing in progress, Shipping*. A **Manager** can **drag a card** to the next stage. (The exact manufacturing stage names are provisional — feedback welcome.)
- 7 **PO number** A real Xero number (e.g. EBUSA26013) once approved; otherwise the card reads “Awaiting Xero PO number”. Each card also shows its route, SKU count and age.

Why? “Awaiting Xero PO number” is deliberate. The Hub isn’t the book of record for PO numbers — accounting is. Rather than invent a number the Hub would later have to reconcile, a card honestly shows it’s waiting, then updates the moment the official number arrives. So you always see the *real* number or a clear “not yet”.

6.1 How to read the PO numbers

The numbers follow **our own entity-prefixed scheme**, so one glance tells you whose order it is and which leg of the chain you’re looking at:

Example	Leg	Meaning
EBUSA26013	Depot → Group	The US depot’s order to EB Group (USD).
EBG26086	Group → SRO	EB Group’s order to EB SRO (GBP), referencing the depot PO.
EBSR026013-01	SRO → Supplier	EB SRO’s order (EUR). The suffix is the document’s <i>purpose</i> : -01 manufacturing spec, -02 shipping/cargo, -03 accounting.

Each leg’s *Reference* points at the number one step up the chain, so the whole journey is traceable from the supplier order right back to the depot request. The full numbering scheme — with a worked example of all five documents — is in the companion document **po-flow.pdf**.

7. The purchase-order document — and where to download the PDF

Click any **card** on the board to open its **detail panel** on the right. The green **Download PDF** button sits right at the *top* of that panel.

1 Download PDF The green button, right at the top — generates the branded purchase order (see below).

- 2 **Status** Where the order is (Requested, Approved, ...).
- 3 **Route** The from → to entities for this leg.
- 4 **Timeline, shipment & attachments** Created/approved dates, the linked Cargo shipment, and any files. Orders that carry line items also show a *Line items & deliveries* section here, with received quantities.

The downloaded PDF is the real, branded document: Echo Barrier logo, the **PO Number** then the **Reference** beneath it, both companies' full **addresses** (From / To), **who approved it**, the line items, and the **total in that leg's currency**.

Why? The total is shown in each leg's own currency — the US depot order in USD, the EB Group order in GBP, the EB SRO order in EUR — even though the cost is only entered once. The Hub converts it automatically at the current weekly rate, because each company's paperwork and accounts must be in *its* currency. Prices are hidden entirely from accounts without cost access (e.g. **Production**), so the same PO can safely go to the factory floor as a spec-only document.

8. Commercial invoices

When a container ships, a **Manager** raises the intercompany **commercial invoice** from the **Invoices** page.

INVOICES

Commercial Invoices
Intercompany invoices issued per container — SRO→Group (EUR) · Group→USA (USD)

Search invoice, route, container

New invoice — from container per container — EUR (SRO → Group) & USD (Group → USA) Destination: E.G., BI

CONTAINER	PO REF	SKUS	UNITS	
BEAU4067822	EBG25119, EBG26002	2	560	EUR USD
CHAU4783188	EBG25111	1	400	EUR USD
CHAU6783741	EBG25112	1	400	EUR USD
FANU3080006	EBG25099	1	560	EUR USD
ONEU6581573	EBG25089	1	560	EUR USD
TCLU7829814	EBG25103	1	560	EUR USD
TIU5900078	— no ref	4	276	EUR USD

INVOICE	DATE	ROUTE	CONTAINER	STATUS	TOTAL	
EBGS2026-00024	2026-07-08	EB-SRO → EB-GROUP	TIU5900078	DRAFT	€9,765.03	Issue Edit Void View
EBGS2026-00023	2026-07-08	EB-SRO → EB-GROUP	BEAU4067822	DRAFT	€13,829.20	Issue Edit Void View

LOGGED IN AS dean@corserv.co.uk

- 1 **New invoice from a container** Pick the container the goods shipped in.
- 2 **EUR / USD leg** Choose the leg: EUR for SRO → Group, USD for Group → USA. The Hub builds the document with values, FX and lines.
- 3 **Issued invoices** Every invoice raised is listed here to review, download or void.

Why? Invoice creation lives on the *Invoices* page (not *Transport*) because that is where someone doing invoicing naturally looks — create and manage in one place.

9. Your role, and why prices are sometimes hidden

Role	Can do
Manager	View & approve POs; receive deliveries; view BOM & costs ; create & view commercial invoices; MRP forecasting; transport.
Sales	Create & send quotes; raise POs; view POs.
Production	View & receive POs; view the BOM (<i>specs only, no prices</i>); transport.

Why? Cost visibility is a separate permission. Warehouse and production staff can see everything they need to receive and build — SKUs, quantities, specs — but not prices. That way the very same purchase order can be handed to the factory floor without exposing commercial pricing.

Found something confusing, broken or missing? That is exactly what this test is for. Please note *which account, which screen* and *what you expected*, and send it back. Thank you for helping shape the Hub.